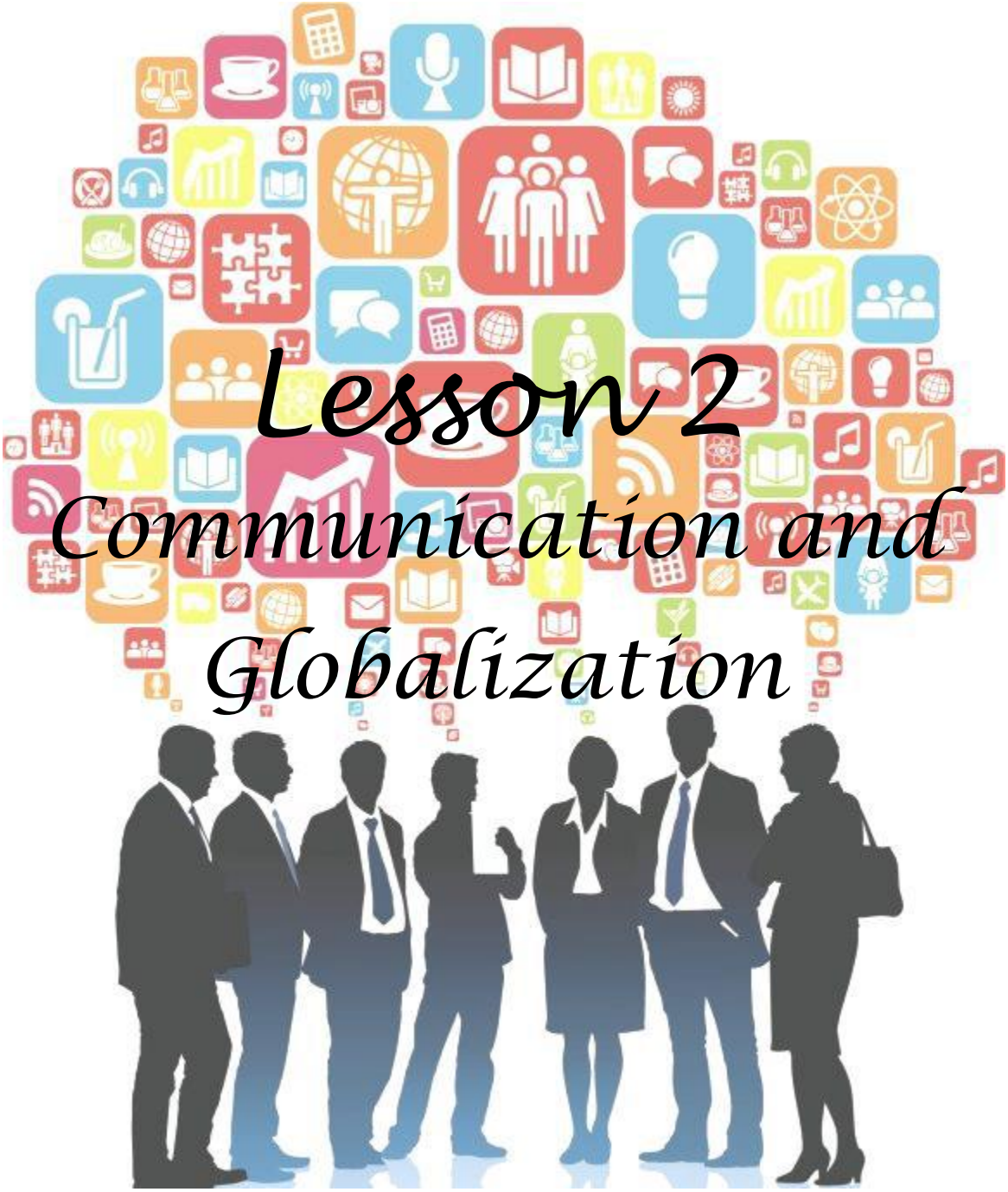
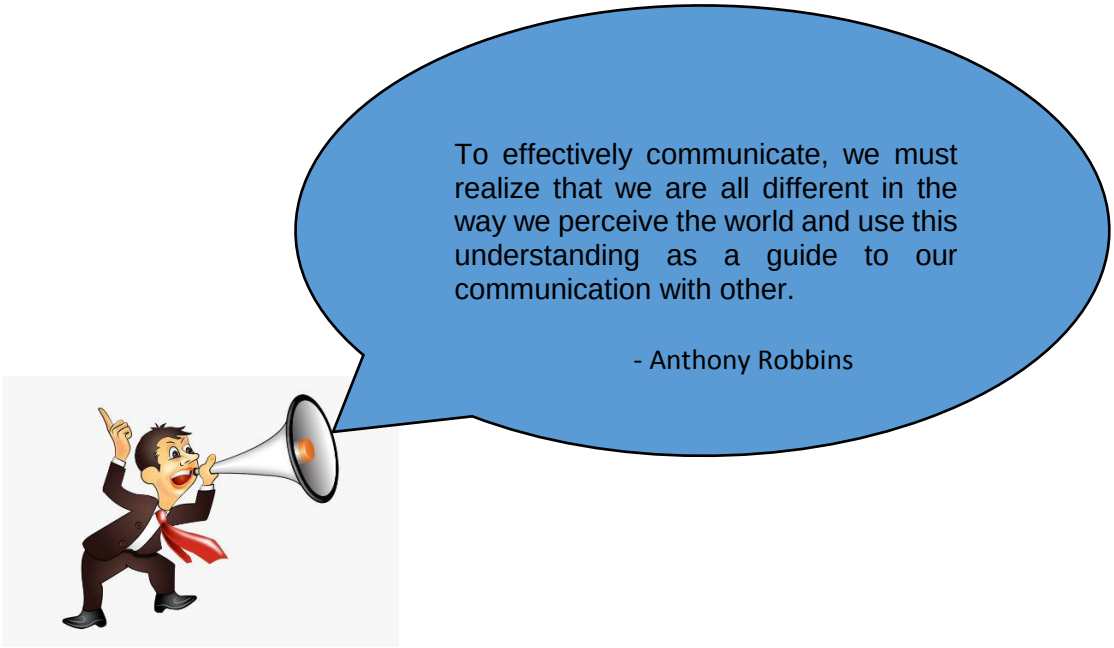


Lesson 2
Communication and Globalization



What is Globalization?

by Rolando A. Bernales, Jocelyn S. Ibones, Maria Edna R. Iñigo, et al.



https://thewinding-road.com/2018/10/09/chapter-thirty-matthew-12-more-sabbath-work/

Globalization is a process of interaction and integration among the people, companies, and governments of different nations, a process driven by trade and investment, aided by information technology (https://www.globalization101.org/what-is-globalization/). This process has effects on the environment, on culture, on economic development and prosperity, and on human physical well-being in societies around the world.

Globalization is not a single process but a complex of overlapping and interlocking processes which are at times, contradictory and appositional. One attempt to reduce globalization to a single theme was forwarded by Kenichi Ohmae's (1989), idea of a borderless and permeable world, which implies that divisions between people previously separated by time and space have become less significant and are sometimes entirely irrelevant.

Intercultural Communication

Everyday communication deeply affects and shows who you are, and a lot of it is cultural. It runs so deep within us that sometimes we do not recognize it in our routine talk and relational dealings and performance.

"Each person is unique genetically. This uniqueness is even more heightened because of forces other than genetics, like family background, religious affiliations, educational achievement, socio-cultural forces, economic conditions and emotional stress that shape human identities. This situation impacts communication. People interacting with those coming from unfamiliar cultures may have difficulties in communication." Madrunio, M.R. & Martin, I. P., (2018).

With developments in science and technology comes connection of people with the world. It has been easier to communicate but problems have developed due to differences in culture. Merriam Webster Dictionary defines culture as "the customary beliefs, social forms, and material traits of a racial, religious, or social group." Even when both parties speak the same language, there can still be misunderstandings due to ethnic and cultural differences (Bernales et al. (2018). Thus, understanding the impact of cross-cultural communication is imperative.

IMPACTS OF GLOBALIZATION ON COMMUNICATION

by Rolando A. Bernales, Jocelyn S. Ibones, Maria Edna R. Iñigo, et al.

In an article entitled the Impact of Globalization and Communication Skills Development, David Ingram said that communication skills development has always been an important factor of success in business, but the influence of globalization and cross-cultural interaction in recent decades has impacted the types of communication skills needed in dramatic ways. No longer can entrepreneurs afford to simply communicate well within their own homogenous culture.

Thus, today, people need to understand the dynamics of long-distance collaboration, the impact of culture on manners of speaking and body language, and how to use technology to communicate with people on the other side of the globe:

1. **Virtual Interactions.** Globalization has introduced virtual communication and collaboration as a major part of academic and workplace dynamics. We need to understand the strengths and limitations of different communication media, and how to use each medium to maximum effect. For example, communicating via email to distant team members require a certain etiquette and nuance not necessarily required in face-to-face interactions. Holding virtual meeting requires a similar change in approach and people who are unaccustomed to communicating in groups in virtual settings can find themselves lost, confused or unable to share their input. This is why in schools; language courses try to address the challenges of virtual interactions.



https://www.business2community.com/strategy/6-simple-rules-hosting-better-virtual-meetings-01697793

2. **Cultural Awareness in Speech.** The need for cultural awareness is a major impact of globalization on the required skill set of effective communicators, resulting in the evolution of communication skills development programs. In the workplace and schools, for example, we need the ability to catch subtle nuances of speech when communicating across cultures. Even when two people are speaking the same language, cultural differences can affect vocabulary, colloquial expressions, voice tone and taboo topics.

3. **Cultural Awareness in Body Language.** Awareness of cultural differences in body language can be just as important as the nuances of speech. This is why in schools, students are taught to understand acceptable speaking distances, conflict styles, eye contact and posture in different cultures. Accepting that the physical expressions of their own culture are not universally accepted. Students are also taught how to address these differences to prepare them for face-to-face meetings with foreign suppliers, customers or term members when they become professionals (review lesson 1 about body language).

4. **Time differences**. The advent of global collaboration introduces another
Collaboration introduces another new dynamic to communication skills – The need to communicate and share information with people across several time zones. When people collaborate with others on the other side of the globe, their counterparts are usually at home asleep while they them – selves are at work. This is why schools teach students to address the to address the nuances of overcoming this challenge by teaching them to understand the information needs of their colleagues according to the communication styles of different countries or cultures.



https://www.bigstockphoto.com/image-310877692/stock-vector-set-of-clocks-showing-the-time-difference-in-different-time-zones-timezone-clock-international-time

Being able to effectively share information between shifts can make or break the productivity of a geographically dispersed team, making this an important issue for many companies. This skill is particularly needed in call centers catering client from countries of different time zones.

IMPACTS OF GLOBALIZATION ON GLOBAL COMMUNICATION

According to Danev (2017), the process of globalization has widely increased the availability of information for people across the world. By the use of Internet and advanced

mobile services, people are able to discuss business plans and proposals on an international level as well as exchange private data securely. Global communication services have also contributed to the enlightenment and development of the political process in a number of states.

Danev (2017) enumerates three major impacts of communication on global communication.

1. **Availability of information**. The availability of information is a major effect of the process of globalization. The World Health Organization, in its works focused on the cultural dimensions of globalization, has expressed the view that with the spread of businesses delivering internet, satellite TV and mobile services, the costs of such information technologies drop. The decreased price makes it easier for people across the world to make use of the World Wide Web and the resources available.

2. **Business Conduct.** Globalization has influenced global communication by implementing new techniques for business conduct among workers at international corporations. Long-distance travels are no longer necessary for business people should they require a meeting with a partner overseas.



https://www.hotelogix.com/business-partners.php

Internet technology makes it possible to exchange business information and conduct video conferences. Additionally, enhanced communication allows business to promote their products more efficiently in the international market. This significantly changed the business world.

3. **Social Awareness.** The availability of information, which is a direct effect of the development of global communication systems, hasled to increased social awareness of people across the world. Information technology and networks enable them to share opinions, views, work on projects and research different areas. These are among the main reasons why the process of globalization is creating a sense of a global society. For example, through the use of communication, many students from the developing countries enroll in university degrees in the developed work.

Education is only a single sector of the social awareness. Other effects, like social determination, have also occurred - the political unrest in Tunisia in the beginning of 2011 had been inspired by opinions and political considerations shared over the social networks available on the web.

IMPACTS OF TECHNOLOGY ON COMMUNICATION

by Mely M. Padilla, Lourdes A. Dagdag and Flordelis R. Rojas

1. **Technology provides us with unlimited information.** What used to take someone hours of searching through a library can now be done within a matter of seconds on the Internet. Whatever questions you have you can generally get an instant answer on the computer. One word of caution though. Make sure that the website you visit and/or the source of information is credible.

2. **It creates opportunities for meeting new people.** Many applications online are currently available for meeting new people anytime anywhere in the world. The applications vary – from posting photos and videos like Instagram, to social networking like Twitter, games like Game of War, or entertainment like textPlus Communities. You should, however, be careful about things that you post on the Internet or about getting too close with an online acquaintance whom you have neither met nor known much more before or else you may eventually find yourself in some kind of predicament.

3. **It helps us keep in touch with family and friends anywhere in the world**. Our being in the 21st century is great; many incredible communication tools have been developed. The tools allow us to get in touch with family and friends, even strangers, anytime anywhere. Computers, smart phones, iPads, and emails, besides the dependable SMS (text message), allow us to communicate quickly and easily.

   Buy an international SIM card, and your cell phone can work everywhere. Be connected to the Internet, and you can make video calls or send chat messages for free via Skype or Facebook messenger. With an Apple product, you can video chat on FaceTime across Apple products anywhere. Finally, and incredibly, with social media's application like Foursquare and Facebook, you can "check-in" to a specific location and share your whereabouts with friends!

4. **It brings new diversity to our culture and our lives**. The pace of change caused by technology is blinding. Google recipes, and anyone, like you and your classmate, can put sumptuous meals on the dining table. Your cell phone, with its digital camera, has replaced the fil camera, and you yourself can print your own pictures without any help from the almost-extinct film developer.

   Before going to your doctor, Google your symptoms and you can confidently discuss your ailment with him. Anytime anywhere you can access your bank online to check your account balance, transfer funds, pay your bills, or verify your transaction details without going to the bank yourself.

   Getting an air ticket is now an easy thing to do, too. Pay online through your credit card; check in using your phone, laptop, or the airline application for easy access; and get your printed boarding pass from the check-in counter at the airport on the day of your flight.

And… to save yourself room undue stress, you can now be assured of a definite place to stay abroad even before your plane lands – just book a room at a hotel in the comforts of your own home days before you fly.

5. **It fosters better cooperation among different cultural groups**. New technologies help companies extend participation on a project to an ever greater number of people, allowing firms to tap into a wide body of knowledge and expertise.

Other Impacts of Technology on Communication

1. **It isolates us. (Turkle, (2012)**

Mobile communication is so powerful that it changes not only what we do but also what we are. Wherever we are, our mobile phones are also there – we are inseparable. At the dinner table with our families, in a meeting at work, during interactions in the classroom, while shopping in malls, in conversations with friend, while listening to presentations in lecture–everywhere, even at the most unlikely places like funerals - the cellphone takes us away from the people around us. It literally isolates us from the rest of the world... from humanity. Sherry Turkle's "Alone together: Why we expect more from technology and less from each other" describes the situation to a tee.



http://7thkingdom.org/2013/03/episode-8-is-technology-isolating-us/

6. **It can make us create second lives.** (Gamble & Gamble, 2013).

Millions of people find solace in virtual communities where they have found a second life. You might have heard of Sim City, Farmville, and Cities Skylines. In these social networking sites, users or players create or choose avatars to interact with other users anywhere in the world. An avatar s an image that represents the player in online games, chat rooms, and so on, which moves on screen, video game avatars are physical entities (the users) that become abstract (as video game guys). People who have second lives seek new people to meet in hopes of experiencing a meaningful relationship. The virtual

community might be providing the players the person-to-person contact they are seeking, which could be absent in the neighborhoods where they live.

Multicultural Communication

All of us exist in a multicultural environment with multiple and overlapping cultures (national, regional, social class, ethnic, age, religion, political affiliation, gender, profession). We learn and imbibe these cultures not only from people we interact with but also from the media, including the internet. This is what makes communication complicated, but if we expose ourselves to and recognize cultural differences, we will lessen our communication difficulties.

"Language, more than anything else, is the heart of culture" (Stevenson, as cited in Lee, 2017; as cited by Padilla, 2018). As far as the English language is concerned, the speaker's culture will influence the use of English. We now recognize the "World Englishes". More on these will be discussed in the next lesson.

CULTURAL AWARENESS AND SENSITIVITY

by Rolando A. Bernales, Jocelyn S. Ibones, Maria Edna R. Iñigo, et al.

Cultural awareness is knowing that there are multiple different cultures-based on religion, ethnicity, nationality and other factors-that have different attitudes and outlooks. Cultural sensitivity involves accepting those differences without insisting your own culture is better, or that everyone should do it your way. Cultural-sensitivity are sometimes called cultural competence, or the ability to work alongside people with different cultural attitudes and behaviors and to do so effectively (Sherman, 2018 as cited by Bernales, et al., 2018).

Cultural sensitivity is being aware that cultural differences and similarities between people exist without assigning them a value – positive or negative, better or worse, right or wrong. It simply means that you are aware that people are not all the same and that you recognize that your culture is no better than any other culture. A challenge, if you ask the author, for members of dominant cultures (https://redshoemovement.com).

According to Dabbah (2017), the idea behind cultural sensitivity is very straightforward. Cultural sensitivity refers to a set of skills that allows you to learn about and understand people whose cultural background is not the same as yours, but what does that really mean? Essentially, it means that, as you go about your daily life, you operate with the awareness that cultural differences between yourself and the people you meet exist without assigning them a value. You see our differences as a positive thing, and don't consider one culture better or worse, right or wrong.

Of course, this is often easier said than done. With increasingly diverse populations living together in the same communities, it is not always possible to intimately understand the backgrounds of those we are interacting with. Having cultural sensitivity does not mean that you must be an expert in each culture's values. It simply means that you're willing to ask honest questions, seek understanding, and demonstrate empathy rather than judging those around you. It also means that, when you knowingly enter a space in which there will be

cultural differences at play, you do a bit of homework beforehand and avoid knee-jerk reactions or jumping to conclusions (Dabbah, 2017).

a. Gender Sensitivity

Gender sensitivity refers to the aim of understanding and taking account of the societal and cultural factors involved in gender-based exclusion and discrimination in the most diverse spheres of public and private life. It focuses mainly on instances of structural disadvantage in the positions and roles of women (http://eige.europa.eu).

Gender-sensitive language is the realization of gender equality in written and spoken language. Gender equality in language is attained when women and men and those who do not conform to the binary gender system are made visible and addressed in language as persons of equal value, dignity, integrity and respect (http://eige.europa.eu).

Avoiding sex- and gender-based discrimination starts with language, as the systematic use of gender-biased terminology influences attitudes and expectations and could, in the mind of the reader or listener, relegate women to the background or help perpetuate a stereotyped view of women's and men's roles. There are number of different strategies that can be used to express gender relationships that refer explicitly or implicitly to only one gender, and ensuring, through inclusionary alternatives and according to each language's characteristics, the use of gender-sensitive and inclusive language.

The site http://www.academia.edu advises the use of Ms. with women as sometimes their marital status is vague or not known if not given special directives from the woman herself (unless the woman herself prefers the courtesy title Mrs. or Miss). A woman's marital status is very often irrelevant to the matter in hand. Also, say Mr. and Mrs. Smith, or Mrs. Jane and MR. John Smith instead of Mr. and Mrs. John Smith. The salutation Dear Sir/Madam is also preferred if the gender of the recipient is unknown instead of using Dear Sir.

Another thing which you must avoid is stereotyping roles and attributes. Stereotyping roles mean when certain jobs are presumed to be performed only by men or women, giving rise to gender-biased terms. Example: John and Mary both have full-time jobs; he helps her with the housework. This sentence can be stated in other way which sounds more respectful and gender neutral: John and Mary both have full-time jobs; they share the housework.

Attributes means usage of certain words which underline stereotypic gendered attributes. For instance: Women are caretakers, gentle and emotional, while mean are achievers, strong and logical.

Gender-sensitive language is not simply terminology and rules which should be carried by a gender-sensitive speaker or writer. It shows that a person respects all persons, favors social equality and equal opportunity and helps avoid ambiguity. Communicating effectively requires respectful treatment of people, and regard for their needs and individuality.

b. Political Correctness

The term *political correctness* is used to describe language, policies, or measures that are intended to avoid offense or disadvantage to members of particular groups in society. Since the late 1980s, the term has come to refers to avoiding language or behavior that can be seen as excluding, marginalizing, or insulting groups of people considered disadvantaged or discriminated against, especially groups defined by sex or race. In public discourse and the

media, it is generally used as a pejorative, implying that these policies are excessive (https://en.wikipedia.org).

Merriam-Webster defines *politically correct* as agreeing with the idea that people should be careful to not use language or behave in a way that could offend a particular group of people (Molloy, 2015).

Other dictionaries give similar definitions, but what political correctness really means is not being a jerk to others. Political correctness is nothing more than treating others with respect. Being kind. Being a nice person. And, yes, this means maybe not calling someone a racial slur and not making judgments or assumptions based on stereotypes (Molloy, 2015). See appendix B for some words that may be used for political correctness.

Non-verbal and Intercultural Communication
by Ronald M. Henson

Non-verbal communication can bridge the gaps in intercultural communication. When there is cultural indifference and one culture is perceived superior to the other, wrong judgement may occur. Non-verbal gestures can help in solving the problem by providing another way of letting people from other cultures connect. This type of communication accounts for 65%-93% interpretation of body language, speech patterns, and facial expressions 65% and gestures.

Your knowledge about the forms of non-verbal communication in lesson 1 will be of much help to you.

Americans can show a big smile to everyone including strangers, all the time, which can be seen as a friendly gesture. For Americans it is a way of making friends. This action shows how non-verbal contributes to overcoming language and cultural barriers, to cultivate mutual understanding. In communicating with people of the same culture, the message transmitted is interpreted it based on the values and beliefs common to all participants of that specific culture. However, when communicators come from different cultures, the message can be interpreted from their own perspective. With cultural difference, gestures and other non-verbal used in communication can somehow bridge between two parties. However, there can be some exceptions to this case are also present.



https://www.theladders.com/career-advice/whats-in-a-handshake-a-clue-to-whether-or-not-youre-hirable

The handshake gesture is a form of haptic communication which lets people communicate through the sense of touch. It is generally considered the proper etiquette when people are introduced to each other for the first time. In athletic competitions, it can also denote sportsmanship and respect in playing the game. It also means trust and equality. However, other cultures may also have different meanings associated to handshakes. In Islamic

countries, handshake is discouraged between men and women as the latter are considered chaste and should not be touched. In Russia, a handshake is rarely performed between opposite sexes as hand-kissing is preferred when greeting a lady. On the other hand, handshakes are the norm for Russian men especially in the context of business.

Aside from haptics, another non-verbal form is called oculesics which focuses on eye movement to convey messages. In Asian culture eye contact shows trust between two people talking and sharing ideas. In some instances, the eye level is lowered when a person talks to a superior as a sign of respect. Meanwhile in Nigeria, it is disrespectful to look at the person in the eye.

Lastly, proxemics speaks of how people use space in the process of communication. Some cultures involve space in certain social situations. For example, in Arab culture, women should walk a few meters away from men unless they are related to each other. It shows high regard to their purity and chastity which is part of the Islam tradition. This custom is very different in the culture of Filipinos who usually interact with each other within close distances even if they are not related by either friendship or marriage.

Ten Commandments of Intercultural Communication
by Ronald M. Henson

The Ten Commandments of Intercultural Communication have been developed by Martin Hahn (2005) as rules to help foster effective intercultural communication. They are as follows:

1. Be aware of differing social values.
2. Be aware of differing status symbols and how to demonstrate them.
3. Be aware of decision-making customs; not all people like to make decisions quickly and efficiently.
4. Be aware of concepts of time; not all people like to see time as money:
5. Be aware of personal space: people from different cultures have different “comfort zones.”
6. Be aware of cultural context; people from certain cultures called (“high-context cultures”) rely less on verbal communication and more on the context of non-verbal actions and environmental settings to be conveying meaning. People from low-context cultures rely more on verbal communication and less on circumstances and implied meaning to convey meaning.
7. Be aware of body language; learn the basic differences in the way people supplement their words with body movement.
8. Be aware of different etiquette rules or manners; what is polite in one culture may be considered rude in another.
9. Be aware of legal and ethical behavior.
10. Be aware of language barriers: English is the most prevalent language in international business, but it is a mistake to assume that everyone understands it.

Some factors to consider fostering effective intercultural communication include the virtue of patience, language fluency, and the use of mother tongue to express feelings whenever the host or other culture’s language is limiting. These factors facilitate recognition of skills and accomplishments, inner strengths and positive personal qualities, humor, and potential for learning new skills in multi-cultural settings (Ishiyama & Westwood, 1992).

Who is then the ethical intercultural communicator? (Kale 1997 as cited by Bermudo et.al., 2018) writes that:

- Ethical communicators address people of other cultures with the same respect that they would like to receive themselves. Intercultural communicators should not demean or belittle the cultural identity of others through verbal or nonverbal communication.
- Ethical communicators seek to describe the world as they perceive it as accurately as possible. What is perceived to be the truth may vary from one culture to another; truth is socially constructed. This principle means that ethical communicators do not deliberately mislead or deceive.
- Ethical communicators encourage people of other cultures to express themselves in their uniqueness. This principle respects the right of people to expression regardless of how popular or unpopular their ideas may be.
- Ethical communicators strive for identification with people of other cultures. Intercultural communicators should emphasize the commonalities of cultural beliefs and values rather than their differences.



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